



2026

History & Geography

Grade 5 · Paper 2 of 4

Theme: French Colonisation, Slavery & Climate of Mauritius

Time allowed: **1 hour** Total marks: **50**

Name: _____

Class: _____ Date: _____

Instructions to Candidates

1. Write your name, class and date in the spaces above.
2. Answer **all** questions in all three sections.
3. For tick-box questions, place a clear tick (✓) in the box next to your chosen answer.
4. Write your answers neatly in the spaces provided. Do not write outside the answer boxes.
5. The marks available for each question are shown in the box on the right.
6. Read each question carefully before you answer.

Mark allocation: Section A — History (25 marks) | Section B — Geography (15 marks) | Section C — Civics (10 marks)

Section A — History of Mauritius [25 marks]

1 For each question below, tick (✓) ONE correct answer.

(a) In which year did France officially take possession of Mauritius? 1

☐ 1710

☐ 1715

☐ 1735

☐ 1810

(b) What did the French rename the island of Mauritius? 1

☐ Île Bourbon

☐ Isle de France

☐ Île Maurice

☐ Nova Francia

(c) Which famous French governor developed Port Louis as a major harbour and city? 1

☐ Pierre Poivre

☐ Mahé de Labourdonnais

☐ François Leguat

☐ Bertrand-François Mahé

(d) Where were most enslaved people brought from during the French period? 1

☐ India and China

☐ Europe and Asia

☐ Africa and Madagascar

☐ Indonesia and Malaya

2 Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

5

"Enslaved men, women and children were brought by force from Africa and Madagascar to work on the French sugar plantations of Isle de France. They had no freedom, no wages, and were treated as the property of their masters. Many attempted to escape into the mountains and forests — these freedom fighters became known as *Marrons*. The mountain of Le Morne Brabant, in the southwest of the island, became a refuge for escaping enslaved people and is today recognised as a UNESCO World Heritage Site. When slavery was abolished in 1835 under British rule, formerly enslaved people were finally free, but many were forced to remain as 'apprentices' for four more years without true freedom."

- (a)** What name was given to enslaved people who escaped to the mountains? [1 mark]

- (b)** Name the mountain mentioned in the passage and explain why it was important to enslaved people. [2 marks]

- (c)** According to the passage, in which year was slavery abolished? Even after abolition, why were formerly enslaved people not immediately fully free? [2 marks]

- 3 Describe THREE effects of French colonisation on Mauritius.** Write two or three sentences for each effect. 6

(a) Effect 1:

(b) Effect 2:

(c) Effect 3:

- 4 Answer the following short questions about the French period.** 5

(a) What crop did the French mainly grow on their plantations in Mauritius? [1 mark]

(b) Pierre Poivre was an important French official. Name ONE thing he is famous for in the history of Mauritius. [1 mark]

- (c) Give TWO conditions that enslaved people suffered during the French period. [2 marks]

- (d) Which European nation took control of Mauritius from the French in 1810? [1 mark]

- 5 Explain why slavery was wrong and how it affected the people of Mauritius. In your answer, refer to at least TWO specific effects of slavery on enslaved people or on Mauritian society.

5

Section B — Geography of Mauritius [15 marks]

6 Tick (✓) ONE correct answer for each question.

(a) What type of climate does Mauritius have? 1

- ☐ Desert climate
- ☐ Polar climate
- ☐ Tropical maritime climate
- ☐ Mediterranean climate

(b) Which months make up the **hot and wet season** in Mauritius? 1

- ☐ May to October
- ☐ November to April
- ☐ June to August only
- ☐ January to June

(c) During which season do most cyclones strike Mauritius? 1

- ☐ The cool dry season (May–October)
- ☐ The hot wet season (November–April)
- ☐ All year round equally
- ☐ Only in June and July

7 Answer the following questions about the climate of Mauritius. 6

(a) Mauritius has two main seasons. Name each season and state the months when it occurs. [2 marks]

(b) The central plateau of Mauritius tends to be *cooler and wetter* than the coastal areas. Give ONE reason for this difference. [2 marks]

- (c) Why is the **east** coast of Mauritius generally wetter than the **west** coast? Mention the *trade winds* in your answer. [2 marks]

- 8 Describe how the climate of Mauritius affects the *daily lives* of its people. Give TWO specific effects and explain how people respond or adapt to each one.

6

- (a) Effect 1 and how people respond:

- (b) Effect 2 and how people respond:

Section C — Civics & Cultural Heritage [10 marks]

9 Tick (✓) ONE correct answer for each question.

(a) Which UNESCO World Heritage Site in Mauritius is directly linked to the history of slavery? 1

- ☐ Aapravasi Ghat, Port Louis
- ☐ Le Morne Cultural Landscape
- ☐ Pamplemousses Botanical Garden
- ☐ Blue Bay Marine Park

(b) Which national day commemorates the abolition of slavery in Mauritius? 1

- ☐ 12 March
- ☐ 1 February
- ☐ 1 May
- ☐ 2 November

(c) Which language, born from the French period, is spoken by the majority of Mauritians in everyday life? 1

- ☐ French
- ☐ English
- ☐ Mauritian Creole (Kreol)
- ☐ Bhojpuri

(d) Sega is a traditional music and dance form in Mauritius. It originated from which community? 1

- ☐ The French colonial settlers
- ☐ Enslaved Africans and Creole community
- ☐ Indian indentured labourers
- ☐ Chinese traders

10 Answer the following questions about cultural heritage in Mauritius. 6

(a) Explain what **cultural heritage** means. Give ONE example of a cultural heritage site or tradition in Mauritius. [2 marks]

- (b)** Why is it important for Mauritians to remember the history of slavery?
Give TWO reasons. [2 marks]



- (c)** Mauritius is described as a "rainbow nation" because of its many cultures. Give ONE advantage of having many different cultures living together in one country. [2 marks]



Mark Scheme — Paper 2 (French Colonisation, Slavery & Climate)

For teacher / parent use only. Accept any answer that is factually correct and shows understanding. Where a specific name or date is required, it must be correct. For explanations, award the second mark for a developed reason rather than bare mention.

Q	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
1(a)	1715	1
1(b)	Isle de France	1
1(c)	Mahé de Labourdonnais	1
1(d)	Africa and Madagascar	1
2(a)	Marrons (also accept Maroon)	1
2(b)	Le Morne Brabant (1 mark); it was a refuge / hiding place for enslaved people who escaped from their masters (1 mark).	2
2(c)	1835 (1 mark); they were forced to remain as 'apprentices' / unpaid workers for four more years (1 mark).	2
3(a–c)	Any THREE from: Port Louis was built and developed as a major city and harbour; sugar cane plantations were established; thousands of Africans were brought as slaves; the island's population grew significantly; French language and culture influenced Mauritius; roads and infrastructure were built; spice cultivation began (Pierre Poivre). 2 marks per well-explained effect; 1 mark for bare statement.	6
4(a)	Sugar cane	1
4(b)	He introduced spice plants (nutmeg, cloves, pepper) to Mauritius / he was in charge of the Pamplemousses garden / he fought against corruption.	1
4(c)	Any TWO from: no freedom / no wages / treated as property / forced to work / separated from family / harsh punishment / poor living conditions. (1 mark each)	2
4(d)	Britain / the British	1
5	Award 2 marks for each specific effect explained (up to 4 marks), plus 1 mark for overall coherence/quality. Effects may include: loss of freedom and dignity; forced labour without pay; violence and cruel treatment; separation of families; cultural suppression; resistance (Marrons); Le Morne as symbol; long-term impact on society. Partial credit for mention without explanation.	5
6(a)	Tropical maritime climate	1
6(b)	November to April	1
6(c)	The hot wet season (November–April)	1

Q	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
7(a)	Hot wet season: November to April (1 mark); cool dry season: May to October (1 mark).	2
7(b)	The central plateau is at a higher altitude / elevation (1 mark), so air cools as it rises and produces more rainfall; temperatures are lower at higher ground (1 mark for development).	2
7(c)	The south-east trade winds blow moisture off the Indian Ocean (1 mark) and drop rain on the eastern side / windward side of the island; by the time wind reaches the west coast it is drier — this is called the rain shadow effect (1 mark).	2
8	Any two effects with adaptation. Examples: cyclones → people board up houses / schools close / warnings issued; heat/humidity → people wear light clothing / stay indoors midday / use fans; heavy rain → flooding in low areas → drainage systems / raised roads; dry season → water shortages → use of reservoirs. Award 2 marks per point (1 for effect, 1 for adaptation), up to 6 marks.	6
9(a)	Le Morne Cultural Landscape	1
9(b)	1 February (Abolition of Slavery Day)	1
9(c)	Mauritian Creole (Kreol)	1
9(d)	Enslaved Africans and Creole community	1
10(a)	Cultural heritage = the practices, traditions, monuments, languages and arts passed down from past generations (1 mark). Any valid example: Le Morne, Aapravasi Ghat, Sega music, Creole language, etc. (1 mark).	2
10(b)	Any TWO from: to honour those who suffered; to understand how society changed; to ensure such injustice never happens again; to respect the descendants of enslaved people; to understand the origins of the Creole community. (1 mark each)	2
10(c)	Any valid advantage: sharing of different foods/music/traditions; tolerance and understanding; rich cultural festivals; tourism; strong community spirit; diverse skills and knowledge. Award 2 marks for a developed point; 1 mark for a bare mention.	2
Total		50